

Window Management

Now let's open a few more windows—double-click the Fonts and Desk.Accs folders. We're not really concerned about the contents of these windows right now; we'll be using them to illustrate a few handy window management techniques. The screen tends to get cluttered when more than a couple of windows are open; these tricks can help minimize the confusion.

You're already familiar with the ways you can manipulate IIGS Desktop windows like those you see in the Finder. You can drag them around, resize them by dragging their zoom box, and you can bring any window to the front by clicking anywhere in it. You can close a window by clicking its close box, by choosing "Close" from the File menu, or by pressing ⌘-W.

You can also close *all* open windows by choosing "Close All" from the File menu. Even experts get confused sometimes, and closing all open windows returns you to a clean Finder slate.

You may also find it useful occasionally to close other open windows as you open new ones. There's nothing at all that says you have to keep the System.Disk and System windows open once you get to the Fonts window. The trick we'll discuss in a minute gives you a way to reopen a window's parent folders without having to go all the way back to the original disk icon.

➡ **Shortcut**

You can also close all open windows by holding down the Option key while you close a window, or while you press ⌘-W. You can drag a window without bringing it to the front of the stack by holding ⌘ as you click in its title bar.

▲ **By The Way...**

We're not quite sure what ⌘-W is supposed to be short for—maybe "window"—but perhaps it was chosen because it's on the left side of the keyboard. It's very easy to zip through Finder windows with your left hand on the keyboard and your right hand on the mouse. The ⌘ key is right there, along with the Shift key for shift-clicking, A for Select All, E for Eject, and W for Close. It's not really a shortcut, just a useful observation.

Another big help is the Window menu. When the window you want to work with is buried under two or three other windows, just pull down the Window menu for a list of all open windows, then select the one you want to work with. No need to close or move the other windows. Or choose Stack Windows from the Window menu; all the windows will arrange themselves neatly on the screen, ready for you to choose one. The order of the windows doesn't change, only their positions. (Open up some windows and try that one out. It's nifty.)

➡ **Shortcut**

Holding down Option while selecting a window from the Windows menu closes it without first bringing it to the front.